

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

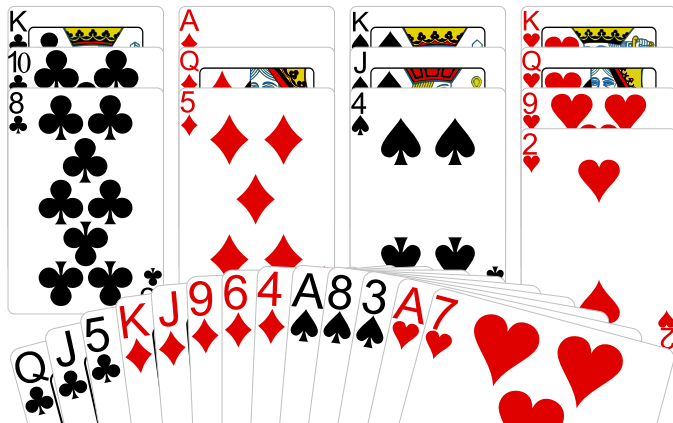
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

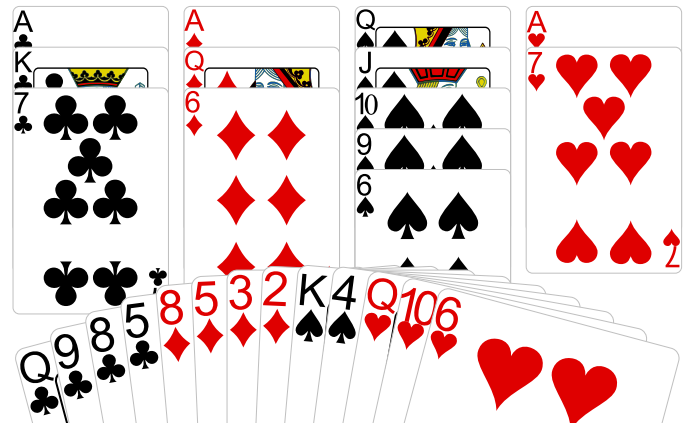
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



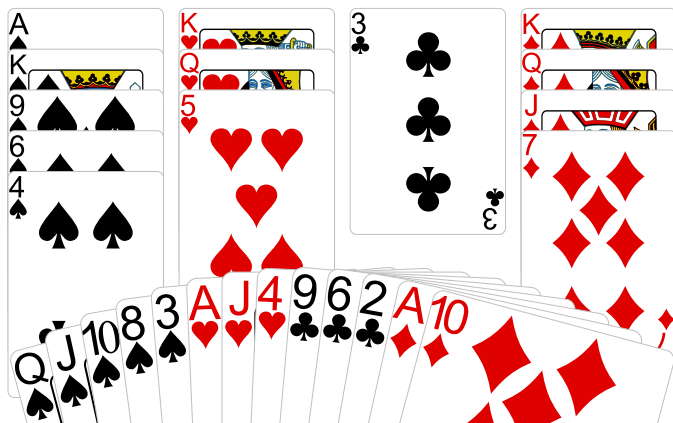
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



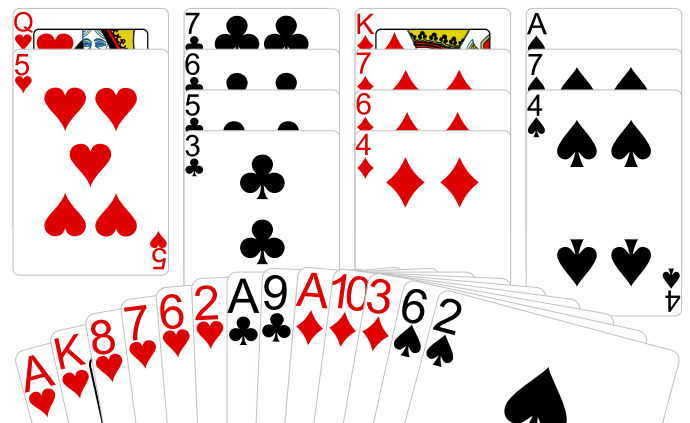
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 6 5
♥ J 6 4
♦ T 7
♣ A 6 4 2

15
5 2
18

♠ A 8 3
♥ A 7
♦ K J 9 6 4
♣ Q J 5



♠ K J 4
♥ K Q 9 2
♦ A Q 5
♣ K T 8

♠ Q 9 2
♥ T 8 5 3
♦ 8 3 2
♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

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With balanced distribution and 16 points
NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1

♦

SOUTH's response is based on simple math.
He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that
NORTH has announced and

comes up with 33 points combined. This is
enough for a small slam, and since he has
balanced distribution

he bids 6NT.

Deal 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J T 9 6
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ A K 7

5
 20 7
 8

♠ 7 5 3
 ♥ 9 8
 ♦ K J T 9
 ♣ J 6 4 2



♠ A 8 2
 ♥ K J 5 4 3 2
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ T 3

♠ K 4
 ♥ Q T 6
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

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WEST is right at the maximum for a 1 ♠ opening bid - one more point and he would

have opened 2 ♣.

EAST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response.

She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

WEST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 7 2
♥ 9 8 3 2
♦ 9 8 6 4
♣ A K 4

18
7 3
12

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ K Q 5
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 3



♠ Q J T 8 3
♥ A J 4
♦ A T
♣ 9 6 2

♠ 5
♥ T 7 6
♦ 5 3 2
♣ Q J T 8 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
5			

♦

would show one Ace, etc).

NORTH has heard enough and bids 6 ♠.

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SOUTH has a minimum 1 ♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect

what's about to befall!

NORTH hears the 1 ♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether SOUTH has one, two or three Aces.

So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

SOUTH has two Aces so she bids 5

♥

(5 ♣ would show zero Aces,

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 2
 ♥ A K 8 7 6 2
 ♦ A T 3
 ♣ A 9

7
 15 9
 9

♠ J 9 5
 ♥ T 4
 ♦ Q 8 5 2
 ♣ K J T 2



♠ K Q T 8 3
 ♥ J 9 3
 ♦ J 9
 ♣ Q 8 4

♠ A 7 4
 ♥ Q 5
 ♦ K 7 6 4
 ♣ 7 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			

4 ♥ by West
 EAST raises to 4



since two trumps is now adequate support.

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WEST has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1



.

EAST, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

WEST shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3



, which

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 6
♥ K T 9 6 5
♦ K T 9 8
♣ J 8 4

14
7 11
8

♠ K Q 7 4
♥ 8 3
♦ 7 6 2
♣ A K Q 2



♠ J T 8 3
♥ A Q 7 4
♦ J 5 3
♣ 7 6

♠ A 9 5 2
♥ J 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ T 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
All Pass			
2 ♠ by North			

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NORTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

SOUTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1



.

NORTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and SOUTH again must bid. Since SOUTH is pretty weak he just

raises to 2 ♠, which NORTH happily passes.